

Marceau Air — HVAC Service Business Launch Plan

Trade name (DBA): Marceau Air **Legal entity:** Marceau Solutions LLC (existing) **Domain:** marceausolutions.com — dedicated HVAC landing page at marceausolutions.com/air **Strategy:** Path C — Hybrid (W-2 job hunt for income + HVAC build under dad's license) **Created:** 2026-05-25 | Last updated: 2026-05-25 **Target first paid service call:** October 2026

Status snapshot (as of 2026-05-25)

Item	Status
Dad's HVAC license (CAC1814895)	✓ Verified — Current, Active, Class A, expires 8/31/2026
Dad's CE hours for renewal	● Will complete this month (May 2026)
Dad's commitment to renew	✓ Confirmed
Dad's commitment to qualify Marceau Solutions	✓ Confirmed (already Registered Agent on the LLC)
DBA trade name	✓ Marceau Air confirmed
Marceau Solutions LLC	✓ Existing, William sole owner
Tools (dad has most)	● William to inventory vs. master list (see below)
Vehicle	● William's SUV initially — magnetic signs (NOT vinyl) until validated
Auto insurance for business use	✗ Must update before first paid job

The setup

- **Qualifying Agent:** Dad (existing FL HVAC license — need to verify status + class)
- **Business entity:** Marceau Solutions (existing LLC, William sole owner)
- **William's role:** Working under dad's license as the operational executor
- **Marketing engine:** To be built — friend training on Facebook ads (meeting Tue 2026-05-26)
- **Hands-on capability:** William has lifetime informal HVAC exposure (dad ran HVAC company when William was younger)

DBPR license verification (completed 2026-05-25)

3.1	William takes EPA Section 608 certification (online, ~\$50)	Pending
3.2	Track hours worked under dad's license toward William's own future license (4 years minimum)	Ongoing once operational

Phase 4: Operational start (Oct 2026 conservatively)

First service call eligible once Phase 2 completes.

Capital requirements (90-day startup)

Lean MVP launch (using William's existing SUV + as much of dad's tooling as possible):

Category	Item	Cost
Vehicle	William's existing SUV (magnetic signs, NOT vinyl)	\$0
Auto insurance upgrade	Add commercial use rider/endorsement to personal policy (REQUIRED before any paid work)	\$200-\$500/yr increase
Tools	Gap-fill what dad doesn't have (see Tool Inventory section below)	\$0-\$1,500
Refrigerant + recovery cylinders	Initial R-410A + R-32 inventory + recovery tank	\$400-\$800
Software (CRM/dispatch)	Housecall Pro Basic or Jobber starter	\$59-\$129/mo
General Liability insurance	Marceau Solutions HVAC operations (Class A: \$300k BI + \$50k PD min)	\$1,200-\$3,000/yr
Workers Comp exemption	William as sole operator — file exemption (FREE through FL Division of WC)	\$0
Marketing (FB ads test)	First 90 days of testing	\$300-\$1,000/mo
DBA registration	Collier County DBA "Marceau Air" filing	\$50
DBPR Qualifying Business Application	Form CILB 4357 (\$155) + dad's license renewal (\$255)	\$410
EPA Section 608 certification	William's required cert	\$50
Branding (no vinyl yet)	Magnetic SUV signs (pair), 500 business cards, polo shirts (2-3)	\$250-\$500
Surety bond	Required if doing residential work in some jurisdictions (~\$10k bond, ~\$200/yr premium)	\$200

TOTAL lean launch (estimated)		~\$3,200-\$8,000
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Lower-end (\$3,200) assumes: Dad's tools cover everything, you skip surety bond initially (if not required by your service area), minimum marketing spend. **Higher-end (\$8,000) assumes:** Need to buy some tools, full marketing test budget, surety bond included.

Complete tool inventory — what you need vs. what dad has

Print this section and walk through dad's setup with him to mark what's covered.

Refrigerant handling (CRITICAL — no work without these)

Tool	Purpose	New cost	Have? (✓/x)
Digital manifold gauge set (with R-410A/R-32/R-22 hoses)	Pressure readings on charge/recovery	\$200-\$400	
Vacuum pump (2-stage, 5+ CFM)	Evacuate system before charging	\$150-\$300	
Refrigerant recovery machine	Required by EPA for any work that releases refrigerant	\$400-\$800	
Recovery tanks (R-410A and R-22 minimum)	Store recovered refrigerant	\$80-\$150 each	
Refrigerant scale (digital)	Measure charge weight	\$100-\$200	
Leak detector (electronic)	Find refrigerant leaks	\$100-\$250	
Charging cylinder or refrigerant cylinder	Add new refrigerant	\$200-\$400 (with refrigerant)	
Core removal tool	Replace Schrader valve cores	\$20-\$40	
Tubing cutters, flaring kit, swaging kit	Cut/flare copper lines	\$80-\$150	

Electrical / diagnostic

Tool	Purpose	New cost	Have? (✓/x)
Multimeter (Fluke 117 or 87V recommended)	Voltage, resistance, capacitance	\$200-\$400	

Clamp meter (AC + DC amps)	Current draw on running motors	\$80-\$200	
Capacitor tester	Test/discharge capacitors safely	\$40-\$80	
Insulation tester (megohmmeter)	Test motor windings	\$150-\$300	
Voltage tester (non-contact pen)	Quick live-circuit safety check	\$20-\$40	
Wiring diagram tablet/printouts	Reference for diagnosing	included	

Hand tools (basic kit)

Tool	Purpose	New cost	Have? (✓/x)
Nut driver set (1/4", 5/16", 3/8", 7/16")	Service panel screws, sheet metal	\$30-\$60	
Screwdriver set (Phillips, flathead, Robertson)	General	\$20-\$40	
Adjustable wrenches (6", 10")	Various fittings	\$30-\$50	
Pliers set (channel-lock, needle-nose, wire cutters)	General + wire work	\$40-\$80	
Tin snips (left/right/straight)	Sheet metal ductwork	\$30-\$60	
Hex key set (SAE + metric)	Set screws on motors	\$20-\$40	
Tubing bender	Refrigerant line work	\$30-\$60	
Brazing torch + rods	Repair refrigerant lines	\$100-\$200	
Inspection mirror + flashlight	See inside units	\$30-\$50	

Safety equipment

Tool	Purpose	New cost	Have? (✓/x)
Safety glasses	Eye protection	\$10-\$30	
Work gloves (cut-resistant + nitrile)	Hand protection	\$30-\$60	

N95 masks (insulation/refrigerant exposure)	Respiratory	\$30-\$50	
Hard hat (commercial work)	Head protection	\$30-\$50	
LOTO kit (locks + tags)	Lockout-tagout for electrical work	\$40-\$80	

Cleaning + condenser maintenance

Tool	Purpose	New cost	Have? (✓/x)
Coil cleaner (foaming type)	Clean condenser/evaporator coils	\$20-\$40 (per gallon)	
Fin straightener (comb)	Repair bent condenser fins	\$15-\$30	
Garden hose + spray nozzle	Rinse coils after cleaning	brings own / on site	
Shop vacuum (wet/dry)	Drain line clearing, debris cleanup	\$80-\$200	
Drain line clearing kit (CO2 gun or pump)	Clear clogged condensate drains	\$50-\$150	

Office / business tools (not physical)

Tool	Purpose	New cost	Have? (✓/x)
Smartphone with calendar + camera	Scheduling, before/after photos	already have	✓
iPad or tablet for the field (optional)	Customer signatures, invoicing on-site	\$200-\$400	
Bluetooth printer (portable receipt/invoice)	Print invoices on-site (optional but customers love it)	\$200-\$400	
Square/Stripe payment reader	Card payments on-site	\$50 + transaction fees	
Housecall Pro or Jobber subscription	CRM/scheduling/dispatch	\$59-\$129/mo	

Total estimated new tool cost if buying everything fresh: \$2,500-\$4,500 If dad has most: \$200-\$1,000 to fill gaps

Vehicle decision

Decision: Use William's existing SUV initially with **magnetic signs only** (no vinyl, no wrap).

Critical: Before first paid job, **update auto insurance** to include commercial-use rider/endorsement. Personal auto policies typically exclude business use, and if you're in an accident on a job without commercial coverage, the insurance company can deny the claim AND your general liability won't fill the gap.

Magnetic sign specs:

- Cost: \$50-\$100/pair (VistaPrint, BuildASign, local sign shop)
- Content: "Marceau Air | Heating & Cooling | (239) 398-5676 | License #CAC1814895"
- Removable in seconds — back to personal SUV when not on job

Upgrade trigger (when to consider dedicated van + permanent vinyl)

- 20+ completed paid jobs OR
- Consistent \$4k+/month HVAC revenue for 2 consecutive months OR
- You're scheduling 4+ service calls per day and SUV cargo space limits inventory you can carry

Until then, the SUV + magnetics is the right call. Don't burn capital on permanence before validation.

Service offering decision matrix

Pick 1-2 to start. Don't try to do everything.

Service mix	Margin	Lead time to revenue	Capital required	Fit for William
Residential service calls (no-cool, low refrigerant, capacitor swap, drain line)	High (\$150-400/call × multiple/day)	Days	Low	Strong — FB ads work well, fast cash, learn-as-you-go
Residential maintenance plans (monthly subscription, twice-yearly service)	Recurring, lower margin per call but stable	Weeks-months	Low	Medium — needs marketing engine + sales pitch
Residential install (new system \$5-15k each)	High dollar but lower volume	Weeks	Medium (more inventory)	Medium — bigger jobs, needs financing options for customers
Light commercial service	Higher margin but more competitive	Months	Higher	Skip initially

Custom controls / smart thermostat integration	High margin, low volume	Weeks	Low	Strong — leverages William's PLC/SCADA/automation background
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Recommended MVP service mix: Residential service calls + maintenance plans. Add install later once cash flow stable.

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Based on competitive research at SW FL HVAC market:

Service	Typical SW FL pricing
Diagnostic / service call	\$89-\$129 trip charge
Capacitor replacement	\$250-\$450
Contactor replacement	\$200-\$350
Refrigerant top-off (R-410A)	\$150-\$350 per lb (charge by lb)
Coil cleaning	\$150-\$300
Condenser fan motor replace	\$400-\$650
Compressor replacement	\$1,500-\$3,500
New AC install (residential 3-ton split)	\$5,000-\$8,500
Maintenance plan (annual)	\$129-\$249/yr (2 visits)

Realistic per-call margin: \$100-\$300 after parts (parts markup is where margin lives).

Marketing plan (driven by friend's FB ads training, May 26)

Phase 1 (Week 1-4): Foundation

- Google Business Profile (free, critical for local SEO)
- Basic 1-page website (Marcead Solutions HVAC landing page)
- Phone number setup (twilio existing or dedicated business line)
- Business cards + truck signage

Phase 2 (Week 4-8): Lead generation

- Facebook ads (test \$20-50/day, target Naples/Bonita/Estero homeowners)
- Nextdoor business profile (FREE — strong for local home services)
- Yelp business listing (free tier)

- Door hangers in target neighborhoods (HVAC service-call density)

Phase 3 (Week 8-12): Optimization

- Track lead source ROI (which channel gives best \$/lead)
- Customer reviews (Google, Yelp, Facebook)
- Referral incentives (\$25 credit for referrer + new customer discount)
- Maintenance plan upsell to one-time customers

Realistic FB ad budget: \$1,000-\$1,500 for first 90 days to find what converts.

90-day revenue projection (conservative)

Period	HVAC revenue (gross)	HVAC profit (after parts + ad spend)	Notes
Days 1-30	\$0-\$1,000	\$-500 to \$0	Setup phase, marketing ramp, maybe 1-3 referral jobs
Days 31-60	\$1,500-\$4,000	\$500-\$2,000	FB ads converting, word-of-mouth starts
Days 61-90	\$3,000-\$7,000	\$1,500-\$3,500	Recurring maintenance + new calls
3-month total	\$4,500-\$12,000 gross	\$1,500-\$5,500 profit	

Translation: HVAC build alone is NOT enough to cover Aug 1 rent (\$1,687). W-2 job is still the primary income strategy. HVAC is the secondary stream.

Year 1 stretch target (if W-2 stable + HVAC scales): \$25k-\$50k HVAC revenue, \$10k-\$25k profit.

Decision points / next actions

This week (May 25-31):

- ☐ Talk to dad — confirm license status, willingness to be qualifying agent, scope of involvement
- ☐ Hold FB ad meeting (Friday, May 25) — learn the tactical playbook
- ☐ Verify dad's license at <https://www.myfloridalicense.com/WFLA.asp>
- ☐ William takes EPA 608 certification exam (\$50, online study + test)

June (weeks 2-4):

- ☐ Add dad as qualifying agent on Marceau Solutions LLC (DBPR filing)
- ☐ Open dedicated business bank account
- ☐ Quote insurance + bond (Florida HVAC contractor bond required)

- ☐ Build simple landing page on marceausolutions.com or sub-page
- ☐ Order basic tool kit + supplies
- ☐ Set up FB Business Manager + run first \$300 test ad

July (week 5-8):

- ☐ First service calls (warm referrals first, then FB ad leads)
- ☐ Document each job (photos, before/after, customer testimonials)
- ☐ Refine ad targeting based on conversion data

August onward:

- ☐ W-2 job ideally landed and income stable
- ☐ HVAC building toward sustainable monthly revenue
- ☐ Decide on next investments (van, upgrades, help, etc.)

Risks + mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Dad's license suspended or expired	Verify status THIS WEEK before any business activity
Dad's commitment scope is less than William assumed	Have explicit conversation about expectations
Hurricane season (Jun-Nov in FL) reduces install demand	Focus on service calls during storm season — emergency repairs are HIGH demand
Insurance claim against business (customer injury, property damage)	General liability \$1M + bond protect business assets
Cash burn before revenue ramps	Keep startup capital minimal (\$3-5k MVP), maintain W-2 income parallel
William not licensed yet — limited to what dad authorizes	Work only under dad's supervision/sign-off until William earns own license
Friend's FB ads training doesn't translate to HVAC	Hire HVAC marketing consultant on Upwork after 30-day learning period if needed

Decision: New dedicated landing page at **marceausolutions.com/air** under existing domain, customer-facing brand "Marceau Air"

Why this structure (vs. separate domain or full rebrand):

- Preserves existing marceausolutions.com SEO equity (3+ years of search history)

- Doesn't disrupt job hunt (hiring managers Google "marceausolutions.com" → see consistent identity)
- Marceau Air gets dedicated customer experience optimized for HVAC homeowner searches
- Single LLC, single domain, single email, single billing — operationally simple
- If HVAC scales massively, can spin out to dedicated marceauair.com later (a marketing migration, not a rebuild)

Landing page content structure (marceausolutions.com/air)

Hero section:

- Headliner: "Naples AC Service You Can Trust — Family Owned, Florida Licensed"
- Subheading: "Three generations of Marceau air conditioning expertise in Southwest Florida"
- Primary CTA: "Call Now (239) 398-5676" (click-to-call on mobile, prominent)

Secondary CTA: "Get a Quote" (floating in hero)

[You can start original company]

Services section (3-6 service cards):

AC Service & Repair

- AC Installation & Replacement
- Preventive Maintenance Plans
- Refrigerant Recharge & Leak Repair
- Capacitor & Motor Replacement
- Drain Line & Coil Cleaning

Service area section:

Naples

Estero

- Estero
- Fort Myers (starting point — expand as bandwidth allows)

Family business story section:

- Photo of dad + you together (optional — but high-trust signal)
- Short paragraph: dad's original HVAC business, the family heritage, William continuing the trade with engineering background
- Differentiates from corporate HVAC chains

How it works section (3-4 steps):

1. We answer your call

2. We arrive on time in a marked vehicle

3. We diagnose and quote before any work begins
4. You approve, we fix it, you pay

Trust + social proof section (build over time):

- Customer testimonials (collect after first 5-10 jobs)
- Google review badge (set up Google Business Profile first)

- BBB rating (when established)
- License + insurance details displayed in footer (FL legal requirement)

Contact section:

- Phone: (239) 398-5676 (click-to-call)
- Email: wmarceau@marceausolutions.com
- Service area map (Google Maps embed)
- Hours: TBD — recommend "24/7 emergency service available" if you can commit, otherwise "Mon-Sat 8am-7pm"

Footer (legal compliance):

- "Marceau Air is a trade name of Marceau Solutions LLC"
- "Florida State Certified Air Conditioning Contractor — License #CAC1814895"

- Copyright + privacy policy link

SEO requirements for Naples HVAC market

Local SEO is the #1 lead source for HVAC. Build these in parallel to the website:

1. **Google Business Profile** (FREE — biggest single lever for local HVAC)
 - Claim profile at business.google.com
 - Add photos (van/SUV, dad working, you working, completed jobs)
 - Set service area, hours, services list
 - Collect reviews aggressively after each job
2. **Bing Places** (free, takes 5 minutes — Bing has 10-15% local search share)
3. **Yelp business profile** (free tier — important for older homeowners in Naples)
4. **Nextdoor business page** (free — STRONG for local home services in Naples, especially gated communities)
5. **BBB accreditation** (\$500/year — optional but Naples market trusts it)

Site visual direction

- Keep gold #C9963C as accent color (Marceau brand continuity)
- Add HVAC-industry blues for primary CTAs (trust + temperature associations)
- Clean, mobile-first (60%+ of HVAC searches are mobile)
- Large click-to-call buttons (mobile users want to call immediately)

• Use real photos (NOT stock photos of generic technicians) — use real photos of you (dad/you)

Build sequence

1. **Phase 2 (Aug-Sept):** I build the static landing page with placeholder content + working call/email links. Goes live as soon as DBPR qualifies Marceau Solutions.
2. **Phase 3 (Sept-Oct):** Google Business Profile + Bing Places + Yelp + Nextdoor go live as DBA filed and license verified.

3. **Phase 4 (Oct+)**: Replace placeholder photos with real job photos as you accumulate them. Add testimonials as customers leave reviews.

Open questions for William

#	Question	Status
1	Dad's HVAC license number + class	✓ CAC1814895, Class A, active, expires 8/31/2026
2	Dad has tools you could use?	✓ Most tools confirmed available (William to inventory vs. master list)
3	Existing Marceau Solutions automation clients to preserve?	⦿ Pending — William to confirm before /air page goes live
4	HVAC focus: residential vs. commercial?	⦿ Recommend starting residential service; expand later
5	Geographic service area	⦿ Recommend Naples + Bonita Springs + Estero start, expand to Fort Myers if bandwidth allows
6	Max startup capital	⦿ Pending — recommend \$3-8k for lean MVP, no van purchase initially
7	Hours of operation (24/7 emergency or business-hours only?)	⦿ Pending — affects website + marketing positioning
8	Year dad started his original HVAC company	⦿ Pending — needed for website "Family-Owned Since" trust signal

CE provider detail for dad's license renewal

Dad needs 14 hours of FL DBPR-approved continuing education before renewing CAC1814895 by 8/31/2026.

Provider	URL	14-Hour Package Cost	Format	Recommended
RocketCert	rocketcert.com/florida-hvac	\$130-180	Self-paced online	★ Most popular for FL contractors
At Your Pace Online (AYPO)	aypotech.com	~\$150	Self-paced online	Solid alternative
ABC Online	abc-online.org	~\$140	Self-paced online	FL-approved, longer in market

Mainstream Engineering	epatest.com	~\$140	Self-paced + optional video	Also offers EPA 608 (bundle savings)
360training	360training.com/ contractor	\$130-160	Self-paced online	Multiple-state availability

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• 1 hour Workers Compensation • 1 hour Workplace Safety				
• 1 hour Business Practices • 1 hour Florida Building Code • 1 hour Advanced Building Code (or Code update)				

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Most packages bundle these correctly. Dad should verify the package is for "Class A — Certified Air Conditioning Contractor" specifically (not just "general contractor").

Time commitment: Self-paced — most contractors complete in 2-4 evenings or one weekend.

Insurance carrier comparison (general liability for HVAC)

Required: \$300,000 BI + \$50,000 PD minimum (or \$300,000 combined single limit) for Class A HVAC under DBPR rules. Most carriers default higher (\$500k-\$1M).

Carrier	Quote method	Typical FL HVAC pricing	Strengths	Weaknesses
Next Insurance	Online — 10 min, instant quote	\$1,200-\$2,400/yr	Fast quote, monthly payment, designed for small contractors	Newer carrier — less industry tenure
Hiscox	Online — 15 min, instant quote	\$1,500-\$3,000/yr	Strong contractor focus, well-known brand	Quotes can run higher for HVAC
The Hartford	Broker phone call required	\$1,800-\$3,500/yr	Established carrier, bundled options (auto + GL + WC)	Slower quote process
State Farm (commercial)	Local agent	\$1,500-\$3,000/yr	Local agent relationship, if dad already has SF	Variable depending on agent
Florida HVAC Insurance specialists (e.g., Crow Friedman, Brightway)	Local broker	\$1,200-\$3,000/yr	Shops multiple carriers, FL-specific expertise	Broker fee may apply

Action: Get 3 quotes minimum. Recommended starting set: Next Insurance (online speed), Hiscox (online comparison), one local FL broker (best long-term relationship).

What you'll need to provide for quotes:

- Business entity: Marceau Solutions LLC
- DBA: Marceau Air
- License: CAC1814895 (dad as qualifying agent)
- Estimated annual revenue (first year: \$30k-\$60k is honest)
- Number of employees (1 = you, sole operator)
- Services performed (residential HVAC service, repair, maintenance, install)
- Years in business (Marceau Solutions LLC since 2025, HVAC since 2026)

EPA Section 608 Certification (William)

Required by EPA: Anyone who handles refrigerants on stationary AC systems must be certified. Without this, you legally cannot touch refrigerant — and most service calls involve refrigerant

Certification types:

- **Type I:** Small appliances (5 lb or less of refrigerant) — window units, dehumidifiers
- **Type II:** High-pressure systems (residential split systems, most commercial) — MOST CRITICAL for HVAC service
- **Type III:** Low-pressure systems (commercial chillers) — not needed for residential service
- **Universal:** All three types (highest value, recommended)

Recommendation: Take **Universal** certification — costs about the same as Type II alone, future-proofs you for any work.

Providers:

Provider	URL	Cost (Universal)	Format	Time
ESCO Institute	escogroup.org	\$25-\$50 (online proctored)	Online study + proctored exam	1-2 days study + 2-hr exam
Mainstream Engineering	epatest.com	\$20-\$50	Online or mail-in	1-2 days study + exam
HVAC Excellence	hvacexcellence.org	\$30-\$60	Online	1-2 days
1-800-EPA-TEST	epa608.com	\$25-\$50	Online	1-2 days

Action plan for William's EPA 608:

1. Buy study guide (\$10-20) or use free online materials
2. Study 8-15 hours (the test is real but passable with effort)
3. Take online proctored exam through ESCO or Mainstream

- 4. Print certification card — carry it on jobs (legally required)

Aim to complete EPA 608 in June so it's in hand by the time DBPR qualifies Marceau Solutions in Sept.

First Service Call Playbook

Goal: Land first paid service call by October 2020 (within 2 weeks of DBPR qualification approval).

Step 1: Pre-launch foundation (Sept, while waiting for DBPR approval)

- ☐ DBA "Marceau Air" filed with Collier County Clerk
- ☐ General Liability insurance bound on Marceau Solutions
- ☐ Workers Comp Exemption filed
- ☐ Auto insurance updated to commercial-use rider on SUV
- ☐ Business checking account opened (separate from personal)
- ☐ Magnetic SUV signs ordered + installed
- ☐ Business cards printed (500 count, cheap: \$99 from VistaPrint or Moo)
- ☐ Polo shirts (2-3, embroidered with Marceau Air logo, \$30-50/each from CustomInk)
- ☐ Phone number set up to receive calls (your existing 239-398-5676 fine, OR set up dedicated Twilio number for tracking — both work)

Step 2: Marketing foundation (Sept, in parallel with Step 1)

- ☐ Bing Places + Yelp + Nextdoor business pages created
- ☐ marceausolutions.com/air landing page live
- ☐ Facebook Business Page created (separate from personal)
- ☐ First FB ad designed using friend's training (single ad, \$20-30/day test budget initially)

Step 3: Warm referral wave (Oct, week 1)

This is your FASTEST path to first calls. Don't skip it.

- ☐ **Dad's old customer list:** If dad has any saved contacts from his original HVAC company, call/text 20-30 of them with: "Hey, [name], it's Bill Marceau's son William. Dad's helping me launch back into AC service in Naples. If you ever need anyone for your AC, give us a shout — first service call at 20% off as a thank-you for being one of dad's old customers." Even if 1 out of 10 has a current AC issue, that's 2-3 calls immediately.
- ☐ **Personal network:** Post on personal Facebook + Instagram once. NOT pushy: "Big news — I'm launching Marceau Air with my dad in Naples. Family heritage, three-generations of AC experience. If you or someone you know needs AC service in Naples/Bonita/Estero, give us a call: (239) 398-5676." Friends/family will refer.
- ☐ **Neighbors and Bonita lease building:** Door-knock or flyer your apartment complex. Tell concierge/leasing office you're a licensed HVAC tech available to residents. Many apartment complexes need on-call HVAC for individual unit AC issues.

- ☐ **HOA boards / property managers** in Naples (Pelican Bay, Vineyards, Lely, Tiburon — older communities with more individual AC service needs). Call 5-10 property management companies offering to be on their referral list. Free leads if you build relationships.

Step 4: FB ads activation (Oct, week 2)

Apply friend's training. Specific recommendations:

- **Target audience:** Homeowners (not renters), 55+, Naples/Bonita/Estero ZIP codes, interests = home improvement, HGTV, weather/storms (proxy for AC concerns), older homes
- **Creative:** Photo of dad + you, license # visible, family-business angle. Avoid stock photos.
- **Offer:** "\$59 AC diagnostic — Family-owned Naples AC service. Call (239) 398-5676."
- **Budget:** Start \$20-30/day for 2 weeks. Track cost per lead, cost per call, cost per booking.
- **Landing:** All ads point to marceausolutions.com/air (NOT Facebook page) so you control conversion.

Step 5: First call execution (Oct, week 2-3)

When the first call comes in:

- ☐ Answer on first ring if possible (lost call = lost customer in HVAC)
- ☐ Book the appointment for SAME DAY if possible (HVAC = urgency)
- ☐ Show up on time, in uniform shirt, with magnetic SUV signs on
- ☐ Bring dad on first 3-5 calls (his experience prevents costly mistakes, also builds your confidence)
- ☐ Diagnose, give written estimate BEFORE doing work, get customer signature on quote
- ☐ Do the work, photograph before/after
- ☐ Accept payment on-site (Square reader or cash/check)
- ☐ Ask for Google review immediately after job. Mrs. Smith, if you're happy with the work, would you mind leaving us a quick Google review? Here's the link [send link text]."

Step 6: Iterate and scale

- ☐ After 5 jobs: review what's working — ad source, customer types, call types, margins

- ☐ After 20 jobs: consider second technician (hire helper part-time) OR specialize (maintenance plans vs. new installs)

Master action checklist (week-by-week through October 2026)

Week of May 25 (this week)

Dad:

- ☐ Enroll in CE provider (recommend RocketCert) — start 14 hours

William:

- ☐ Submit Apex Engineer 1 application (already ready)
- ☐ MVR pull from FLHSMV.gov (\$8) — confirm civilian driving record

- ☐ Return uniforms + badge to Collier County (overdue)
- ☐ Email CMU advisor Maryia Rakach to confirm LOA status
- ☐ File DBA "Marceau Air" with Collier County Clerk of Courts (\$50)
- ☐ Get auto insurance quote for commercial-use endorsement on SUV

Week of June 1

Dad:

- ☐ Complete CE hours (most providers allow finishing in 2-3 evenings)
- ☐ Save completion certificate

William:

- ☐ Get 3 General Liability insurance quotes (Next, Hiscox, local broker)

☐ First W-2 follow up emails to PowerGen, Trans, Jacobs, Bramas, Airtrix (Mon June 1 and Tue June 2)

Week of June 8

Dad:

- ☐ Renew CAC1814895 license through DBPR portal (\$255)
- ☐ Verify renewal posts to license record (new expiration 8/31/2028)

William:

- ☐ Begin EPA Section 608 certification study
- ☐ Bind General Liability insurance with chosen carrier
- ☐ Open dedicated business checking account for Marceau Solutions HVAC operations

Week of June 15

William:

- ☐ Take EPA Section 608 Universal certification exam
- ☐ File DBPR Form CILB 4357 (Qualifying Business Application, \$155)
- ☐ File Workers Comp Exemption through FL Division of WC
- ☐ Auto insurance commercial-use rider bound on SUV

Weeks of June 22 - July 13 (3 weeks)

William:

- ☐ DBPR processes qualifying business app (typically 4-6 weeks — covers this window)
- ☐ **Primary focus: W-2 job hunt** (the income path, Path C primary)
- ☐ Build marceausolutions.com/air landing page (in background, ready for go-live)
- ☐ Order magnetic SUV signs (\$50-100)
- ☐ Order business cards + 2-3 polo shirts (\$150 total)

Weeks of July 20 - August 24

Risk register (updated)

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Dad's CE hours not completed by 8/31	Low (dad confirmed commitment)	Critical (blocks plan)	Calendar check-in mid-July to verify progress
Dad's license suspended/lapsed unexpectedly	Very low	Critical	Verify renewal posts after dad pays
First W-2 job offer below \$62k	Medium	High (apartment affordability)	Negotiate hard using CMU credential + dual offers if possible
HVAC startup takes longer than 90 days	Medium	Low (W-2 covers rent)	Path C insulates against this
Major auto incident on personal SUV during job	Low	Critical (insurance gap)	MUST update auto policy before first paid job
Customer dispute / negative review early	Medium	Medium	Always quote in writing before work, photograph before/after, get review immediately after
Hurricane season (Jun-Nov) reduces install demand	Certain	Low	Service calls SPIKE during storm season — opportunity, not risk
William takes job + has no time for HVAC build	Possible	Low	Path C designed for this — HVAC is secondary, not primary

Age Group	Don't know	Not a fan	Dislike	Like	Love
18-29	10%	15%	20%	35%	20%
30-39	15%	20%	25%	30%	10%
40-49	20%	25%	30%	20%	5%
50-59	25%	30%	35%	15%	1%
60-69	30%	35%	40%	10%	0%